

1.5

Thinking time and turn-taking

Worksheet

A Practise this conversation extract. Put a short pause after each underlined 'filler'.

Did you see that programme last night? (1) Well, it was all about the crime problem in American cities. It was presented by that man, (2) you know, the one with the glasses. (3) Anyway, they said it's all because of violence on TV. (4) Still, I suppose it could be worse. (5) So, what were you saying about Andrew? (6) By the way, did you hear about my sister's operation? (7) Actually, she's recovering very well. (8) So, what are you doing at the weekend? Are you going to your parents – (9) I mean you often go there, don't you? (10) Anyway, I have to go now. Give my love to the kids. Bye!

Study each example 1–10 and decide if:

- | | | |
|---|---|-----------|
| a | the speaker continues with the same topic | (1) _____ |
| b | the speaker goes back to a previous topic | (3) _____ |
| c | the speaker prepares to introduce a new topic | (6) _____ |

B Study the table below.

Gaining time to think	Well,, you know, ...
Explaining what you just said	I mean ... Well, ...
Saying something surprising (or true)	Actually, ... In fact, ...
Going back to a previous topic	So, ... Anyway, ...
Saying something is not worth worrying about	Still, ...
Changing the topic	So, ... By the way, ... Anyway, ...
Closing a topic by summarizing in a few words	Anyway, ...
Showing you want to end the conversation	Anyway, ... (followed by a long pause)

Now look back at section A and use the table to check how each underlined filler is being used. For example, filler (1) is used for 'Gaining time to think'.

C Fill in the gaps using words and phrases from section B. Several answers may be possible.

- _____, let me see.
- It's a very good restaurant. _____, it's probably one of the best in town.
- (after talking a long time about your holidays) _____, we had a wonderful time.
- (after talking about your holidays) _____, what are you doing at the weekend?
- He was a bit, _____, strange.
- _____, it's not the end of the world, is it?
- You! Go on a diet! _____ you're not exactly fat!
- _____, what were you saying about Fernanda and Marco?
- _____, that's not really what happened.
- (there's no more to say) _____, I guess you've got a lot to do this afternoon.